8.2. Domain-specific languages

CoffeeScript is a general-purpose programming language. It may be better suited to some tasks than to others, but the *intention* is that it can be used to solve any programming problem. In contrast, the intention of a DSL is to solve a particular type of problem.

This goes hand in hand with the idea that you should describe your program how you like and then worry about the implementation later. The way you *like* to describe your program may be a natural language such as English, a general-purpose programming language like CoffeeScript, or a more focused DSL designed to solve specific problems.

In this section you'll learn the difference between internal and external DSLs; different techniques for creating internal DSLs using object literals, fluent interfaces, and functions; and finally how to approach the construction of an internal DSL.

8.2.1. External DSLs

Imagine for a minute that CSS doesn't exist. How would you use CoffeeScript to style elements in a simple HTML document?

```
<html>
<p>
It is <strong>very</strong> important that you understand this...
</p>
```

Making text contained in a `<strong>` element bold and red could be done by directly manipulating those properties:

```
strongElements = document.getElementsByTagName 'strong'
for strongElement in StrongElements
  strongElement.fontWeight = 'bold'
  strongElement.color = 'red'
```

That would quickly get tedious. You could create a better syntax out of that, perhaps by declaring style rules with objects and then using those objects to